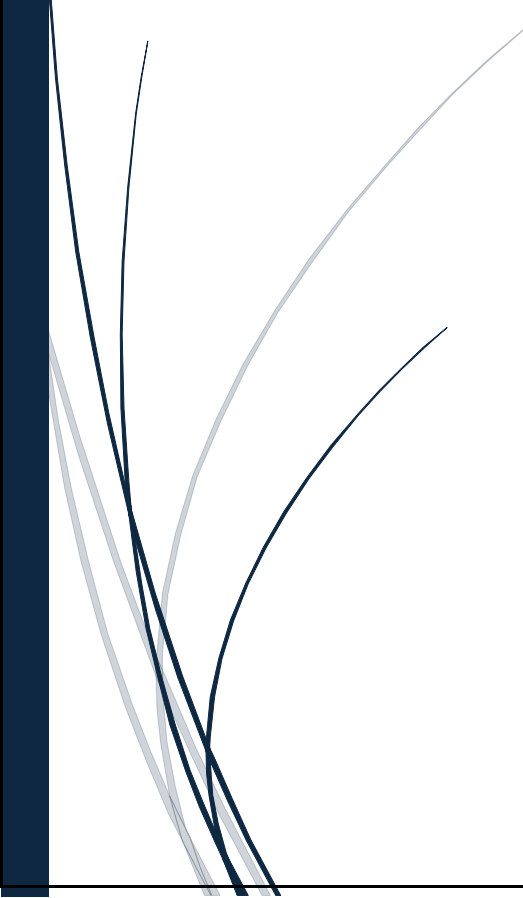




Supply Chain Finance Opportunity Report

Supply chain finance · Haball · Veem · C2FO



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FUTURE TECHNOLOGIES

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Haball, Veem & C2FO: Global SCF Benchmarks for Pakistan's Digital Retail Banking Strategy

1. Executive Summary

This report benchmarks three SCF models—Haball, Veem and C2FO—to identify relevant approaches for Pakistan. Haball represents an anchor-led, bank-partnered SCF model combining Islamic financing, digital payments and SME/distributor financing. Veem focuses on digital cross-border B2B payments, while C2FO operates a working-capital marketplace enabling early supplier payments and dynamic discounting.

The Pakistan opportunity was assessed across 41 districts, 17 value chains and ~7 million SMEs during 2016–2025. The analysis shows an average SCF Opportunity Score of 63.72 (Medium), a Working Capital Gap Score of 72.97, and 53% banking penetration, indicating significant unmet working-capital demand.

85.71% of districts have anchor-firm presence, supporting an anchor-led SCF model. Punjab records the highest opportunity score at 68.82, followed by Sindh (63.73), KP (61.61) and Balochistan (60.20). Key opportunities are concentrated in Light Engineering, Textile, Manufacturing, Fisheries and Agriculture.

Product mapping shows strongest potential for PO Finance, Inventory Finance, Payables Finance and Receivables Discounting, with product selection varying by value chain, anchor presence and export orientation.

The report combines SCF market analysis and Power BI visualizations, with the underlying data cleaning, processing, scoring and analytical work completed in Jupyter Notebook. The complete processed dataset and detailed data-processing methodology are available in the accompanying Jupyter Notebook.

For DRB, the findings support a digital, anchor-led and transaction-based SCF model, combining relevant elements of the three benchmark models to provide scalable working-capital solutions to Pakistan's SME supply chains.

Report Components & Data Methodology Note:

*This report covers three SCF benchmark models—**Haball, Veem and C2FO**—along with Pakistan's SCF market analysis and Power BI visualizations. All underlying SCF market data was processed and analyzed in **Jupyter Notebook**, including data cleaning, validation, scoring, calculations and dataset preparation. The complete processed dataset and detailed analytical workflow are available in the accompanying Jupyter Notebook, while **Power BI** was used to visualize the processed data and present key market insights.*

2. What is Supply Chain Finance?

Supply Chain Finance (SCF) refers to financing solutions that optimize working capital for buyers and suppliers by leveraging the credit strength of anchor buyers and the transaction data flowing between supply chain participants. SCF is not a single product—it is a set of techniques deployed at different points in the purchase-to-pay cycle.

2.1. Why businesses use SCF?

- Suppliers face a cash-flow gap: they deliver goods/services but wait 30-90+ days for payment. SCF converts approved invoices into immediate cash.
- Buyers can extend payment terms without damaging supplier relationships by enabling suppliers to receive early payment from a financier.
- Banks gain access to short-tenor, self-liquidating, anchor-backed credit assets with transaction visibility.

2.2. Core SCF Mechanisms:

Mechanism	Who Benefits	How It Works	Risk Bearer
Payables Finance (reverse factoring)	Suppliers get early payment; buyer extends terms	Bank pays supplier early; buyer repays bank at maturity	Bank, backed by anchor credit
Receivables Discounting	Supplier	Supplier sells invoices to financier at discount	Financier
Dynamic Discounting	Supplier (chooses rate); Buyer (uses own cash)	Supplier offers discount for early payment; buyer decides	Buyer (uses own balance sheet)
Purchase Order Finance	Supplier	Financing against confirmed PO before delivery	Financier, with PO as collateral
Distributor/Channel Finance	Distributors	Anchor facilitates financing for distributors to buy inventory	Bank/Financier, anchored

2.3. SCF Ecosystem Mapping

The Supply Chain Finance (SCF) ecosystem connects buyers/anchor firms, suppliers/distributors, digital platforms, and financial institutions to improve access to working-capital financing.

Buyer/Anchor → Digital Platform → Supplier/Distributor → Financier/Bank

- **Buyer/Anchor:** Provides credit strength and payment commitments, helping establish the reliability of transactions.
- **Digital Platform:** Captures invoice and transaction data and enables API/ERP integration for greater visibility and automation.
- **Supplier/Distributor:** Uses SCF solutions to address working-capital requirements and manage cash-flow gaps.
- **Financier/Bank:** Provides financing based on transaction data, payment commitments, and credit/risk assessment.

This ecosystem enables faster financing, improved cash-flow management, and better risk visibility across the supply chain.

3. Haball Business Model

3.3. Company Overview

Haball, founded in Karachi in 2017, is a B2B fintech focused on digital supply-chain payments and financing. It connects corporate anchors, SMEs, distributors, and financial institutions through digital infrastructure.

3.4. Core Products

- **Wisaaq:** Digital Islamic Supply Chain Financing platform launched with Meezan Bank and Coca-Cola Beverages Pakistan (CCI) in 2022. It connects corporates, SMEs, and banks for Shariah-compliant financing.
- **B2B Payments:** Digital invoicing, payment initiation, tax compliance, and collection workflows.
- **Digital Invoicing:** Haball was the first fintech to receive a digital invoice license from Pakistan's FBR.

3.5. Funding & Scale

Haball announced a \$52 million pre-Series A financing in 2025, comprising \$5 million equity and \$47 million in strategic financing from Meezan Bank. The financing model relies on partnerships with regulated banks rather than Haball lending primarily from its own balance sheet.

3.6. Company-reported scale:

- \$3B+ payments processed
- \$110M+ financing disbursed
- ~8,000 SMEs and multinationals served

3.7. Key Partnerships & Positioning

Area	Haball
Target Customers	Corporate anchors, SMEs & distributors
Core Product	Wisaaq Islamic SCF + B2B payments
SCF Model	Anchor-led supplier/distributor financing
Financing Model	Bank-funded, partnership-based
Digital Infrastructure	Invoicing, payments, financing & tax workflows
Bank Integration	Meezan Bank, Bank Alfalah and other partners
SME Focus	~8,000 SMEs served
Islamic Finance	Core offering through Wisaaq
Revenue Model	Not publicly disclosed
Key Differentiator	Digital, bank-partnered and Shariah-compliant SCF

3.8. Haball: Relevance to Pakistan's SCF Market

Haball's model is particularly relevant to Pakistan because it addresses three key market conditions: SME financing constraints, fragmented supply chains, and growing demand for digital and Shariah-compliant finance.

3.9. Why the Anchor Model Works

Large sectors such as FMCG, textiles, pharma, and energy operate through extensive supplier and distributor networks. While anchor companies generally have stronger credit profiles and transaction data, smaller suppliers and distributors often face working-capital shortages and limited access to formal credit.

The anchor-led SCF model addresses this gap by using the anchor's credit strength, transaction history, and payment commitments to facilitate financing for smaller supply-chain participants.

3.10. Islamic SCF Opportunity

Pakistan's large Islamic banking market creates an additional opportunity for Shariah-compliant SCF. Wisaaq demonstrates how digital platforms can enable Islamic banks to provide working-capital financing with digital disbursement, transaction visibility, and repayment processes.

3.11. Sector Applicability

- **FMCG:** Proven through CCI Pakistan and other corporate relationships.
- **Textiles:** Large supplier networks and significant working-capital requirements create strong SCF potential.
- **Pharma:** Distributor and supplier financing can address recurring working-capital needs.
- **Agriculture & Agri-processing:** Processors can serve as anchors for fragmented supplier networks.
- **Manufacturing & Retail:** Anchor-led distributor financing can be extended across organized supply chains.

3.12. Bank–Fintech Partnership Model

Haball demonstrates a model where the fintech provides the digital platform, transaction infrastructure, and supply-chain connectivity, while banks provide the financing. This allows banks to enter digital SCF without building the entire technology and ecosystem internally.

3.13. Relevance for a Digital Retail Bank:

A DRB could adopt a similar approach by partnering with an SCF fintech, leveraging its existing technology and supply-chain network while focusing on financing, risk management, and customer acquisition.

4. Veem Business Model

4.3. Company Overview

Veem (formerly Align Commerce) was founded in San Francisco in 2014 by Marwan Forzley and Aldo Carrascoso. It is a global B2B cross-border payments fintech that enables businesses to send and receive funds internationally. The platform initially used blockchain technology as a settlement rail and has expanded into broader digital payment solutions.

4.4. Core Business

Veem is not a traditional Supply Chain Finance (SCF) platform. Its primary business is cross-border B2B payments rather than invoice financing or working-capital lending. Its relevance to SCF is therefore indirect: by reducing cross-border payment friction, Veem supports international trade flows and provides infrastructure through which trade-related funds can move efficiently.

4.5. Key Products

- **Cross-Border B2B Payments:** International payments across 100+ countries and 80+ currencies.
- **Mass Pay:** Enables businesses to make batch payments to multiple vendors and contractors.
- **Pay Solution:** Embedded payment APIs that allow platforms to integrate payment capabilities.
- **Virtual Cards:** Expanded payment options, including stablecoin-funded cards accepted across international markets.

4.6. Scale & Funding

- 1.5M+ clients
- \$10B+ payments sent over the last decade
- Licensed as a money transmitter across 46 U.S. states
- SOC 2 and PCI-DSS compliance

Veem has raised approximately \$92.6 million from investors including Kleiner Perkins, GV (Google Ventures), Goldman Sachs, Silicon Valley Bank, and Citi.

4.7. Business Model Summary

Area	Veem
Primary Business	Cross-border B2B payments
Target Customers	SMEs, freelancers, e-commerce & businesses
Payment Model	Digital cross-border payment infrastructure
SCF Relevance	Indirect — payment infrastructure rather than invoice financing

Working-Capital Relevance	Speeds up payment flows but does not directly finance receivables
Cross-Border Capability	100+ countries, 80+ currencies
Digital Infrastructure	API-based and embedded payment capabilities
Key Differentiator	Cross-border payment infrastructure with multiple settlement and payment options
Financing Model	Not a balance-sheet SCF lender

4.8. Veem's Relevance to Supply Chain Finance

Veem's role in the SCF ecosystem is best understood as a payment layer rather than a financing layer. Unlike SCF platforms that assess invoices, evaluate buyer credit, or arrange supplier financing, Veem primarily facilitates the movement of funds.

This distinction is important for a Digital Retail Bank evaluating SCF opportunities. Veem demonstrates how digital payment infrastructure can support trade and supply-chain transactions, but financing, credit assessment, and working-capital solutions would need to be provided separately by a bank or financing partner.

4.9. Key Takeaway

Veem moves money; SCF platforms finance trade receivables. Veem's main value to the SCF ecosystem is therefore its cross-border payment and API infrastructure, which can complement trade-finance products rather than replace them.

5. C2FO Business Model

5.3. Company Overview

C2FO, founded in Kansas City in 2008, describes itself as an on-demand working-capital platform. It operates a global marketplace that helps businesses provide suppliers with early access to payments.

5.4. Core Business Model

C2FO's core model is dynamic discounting and payables finance:

1. The buyer approves an invoice for early payment.
2. The supplier selects its preferred discount rate through Name Your Rate®.
3. The buyer accepts or declines the proposed rate.
4. The supplier receives early payment, typically within 24–48 hours.

A key feature is that buyers can use their own cash to pay suppliers early in exchange for a discount. Banks and third-party funders can also provide financing when buyers prefer not to use their own liquidity.

5.5. Scale & Funding

- \$500B+ cumulative funding to suppliers
- 1M+ businesses across 180+ countries
- \$13B provided to 20,000+ businesses in developing countries in 2024
- C2FO reports zero credit losses

In April 2025, C2FO raised \$30 million in Series I funding led by IFC, supporting its expansion in emerging markets.

5.6. Business Model Summary

Area	C2FO
Primary Business	On-demand working-capital marketplace
Target Customers	Large enterprises and their suppliers
SCF Model	Dynamic discounting / payables finance
Supplier Finance	Early payment against approved invoices
Funding Sources	Buyer cash and third-party funders
Platform Model	Marketplace connecting buyers and suppliers
Global Reach	180+ countries, 1M+ businesses
Key Differentiator	Supplier-controlled pricing through Name Your Rate®

5.7. C2FO — Relevance to Supply Chain Finance (SCF)

C2FO is directly relevant to SCF because its core model provides working-capital financing to suppliers against approved invoices. It connects corporate buyers, suppliers, and financial institutions through a digital marketplace, enabling early payment, payables finance, receivables financing, and dynamic discounting.

5.8. Relevance for the Digital Retail Bank:

C2FO demonstrates how a DRB could build a digital supplier-financing marketplace, allowing corporate anchors to connect their suppliers with Islamic SCF financing while using transaction and invoice data for automated credit assessment.

5.9. Key Takeaway:

C2FO demonstrates a scalable, supplier-focused SCF marketplace that unlocks working capital through approved invoices, early payments, and dynamic discounting. For a Digital Retail Bank, its model highlights how technology and anchor-buyer relationships can enable efficient supplier financing while reducing reliance on traditional lending processes.

6. Comparative Benchmark: Haball vs. Veem vs. C2FO

Dimension	Haball	Veem	C2FO
Geography	Pakistan-focused	Global	Global
Primary Focus	Islamic SCF + B2B payments	Cross-border B2B payments	Working-capital marketplace
SCF Relevance	Core	Indirect	Core
Supplier Finance	Yes	No	Yes
Invoice Financing	Yes	No	Yes
Payables Finance	Yes	No	Yes
Dynamic Discounting	Not core	No	Core
B2B Payments	Yes	Core	Ancillary
Bank Partnerships	Meezan, Bank Alfalah & others	Payment/financial partners	Banks & institutional funders
Digital Platform	End-to-end SCF & payments	Payment API & infrastructure	Marketplace + ERP integration
Islamic Finance	Core	No	No
Cross-Border Payments	Limited	Core	Not primary
Anchor-Based Model	Yes	No	Yes — enterprise buyers
SME Focus	High	High	High
Geographic Scalability	Moderate	High	High

6.3. Strategic Role Interpretation

- **Haball:** Demonstrates how SCF infrastructure can be built around local supply chains, bank partnerships, and Islamic finance.
- **Veem:** Demonstrates the role of digital payment infrastructure, particularly for cross-border trade.
- **C2FO:** Demonstrates how a marketplace and dynamic-discounting model can improve supplier liquidity while allowing buyers to use their own cash or external funders.

6.4. Key Takeaway for a Digital Retail Bank

The three models highlight different opportunities within the SCF ecosystem: Haball combines financing and payments, Veem focuses on payment infrastructure, while C2FO connects buyers and suppliers through a working-capital marketplace. A Digital Retail Bank could evaluate these models as potential approaches for developing its own SCF offering or partnering with specialized fintech infrastructure.

7. SCF Analysis & Dashboard Development Workflow

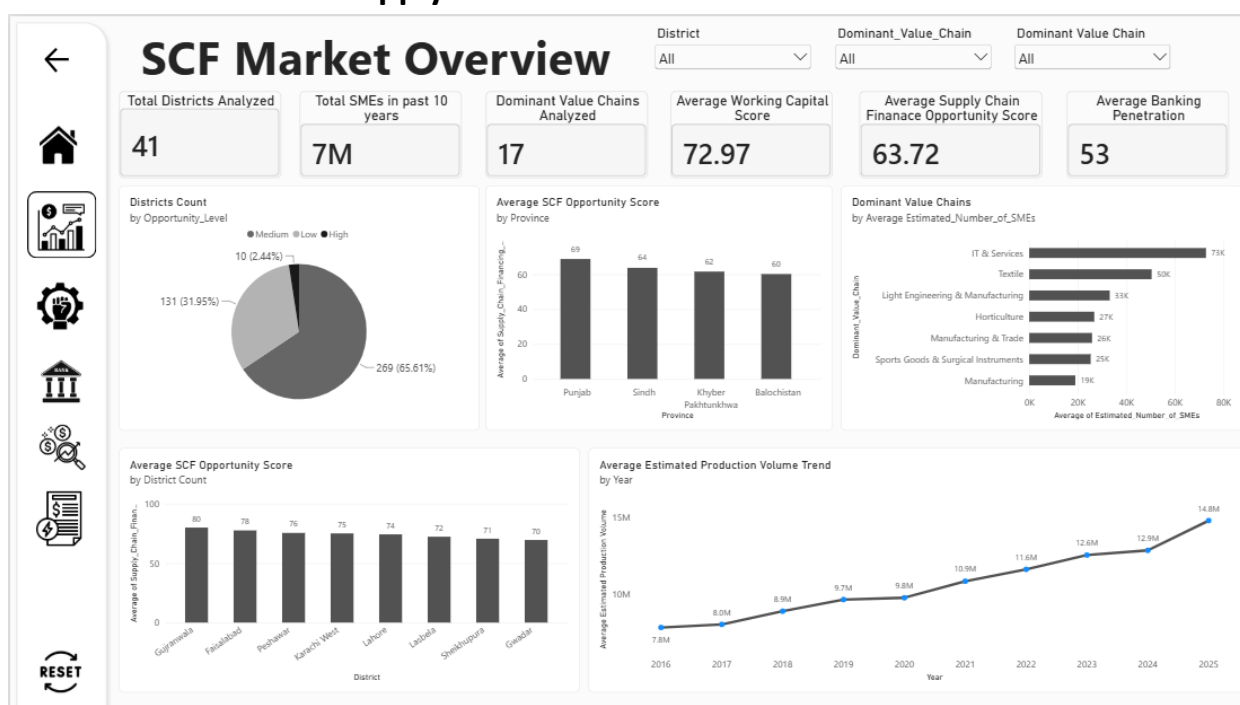
The SCF analysis followed a structured workflow beginning with **data validation and preparation in Python/Jupyter Notebook**, including quality checks for data types, missing values, duplicates, and inconsistencies. The data was then **processed and feature-engineered** through cleaning, standardization, indicator development, and scoring to create the final analytical dataset.

This dataset was subsequently analyzed in **Power BI through exploratory data analysis (EDA)** to identify key trends, geographic variations, financing gaps, supply-chain strengths, and sector opportunities. The findings were translated into five management dashboards covering **SCF Market Overview, Supply Chain Strength, Financing Gap & Accessibility, SCF Opportunity, and Recommended SCF Products**, providing actionable insights for **priority districts, value chains, financing needs, and SCF product selection**.

7.3. SCF Opportunity Report Dashboards

The findings were translated into five management dashboards covering **SCF Market Overview, Supply Chain Strength, Financing Gap & Accessibility, SCF Opportunity, and Recommended SCF Products**, providing actionable insights for **priority districts, value chains, financing needs, and SCF product selection**.

7.3.1. Dashboard 1: Supply Chain Finance Market Overview



Purpose: High-level overview of market scale, financing need, banking penetration, and geographic opportunity before district-level deep dives.

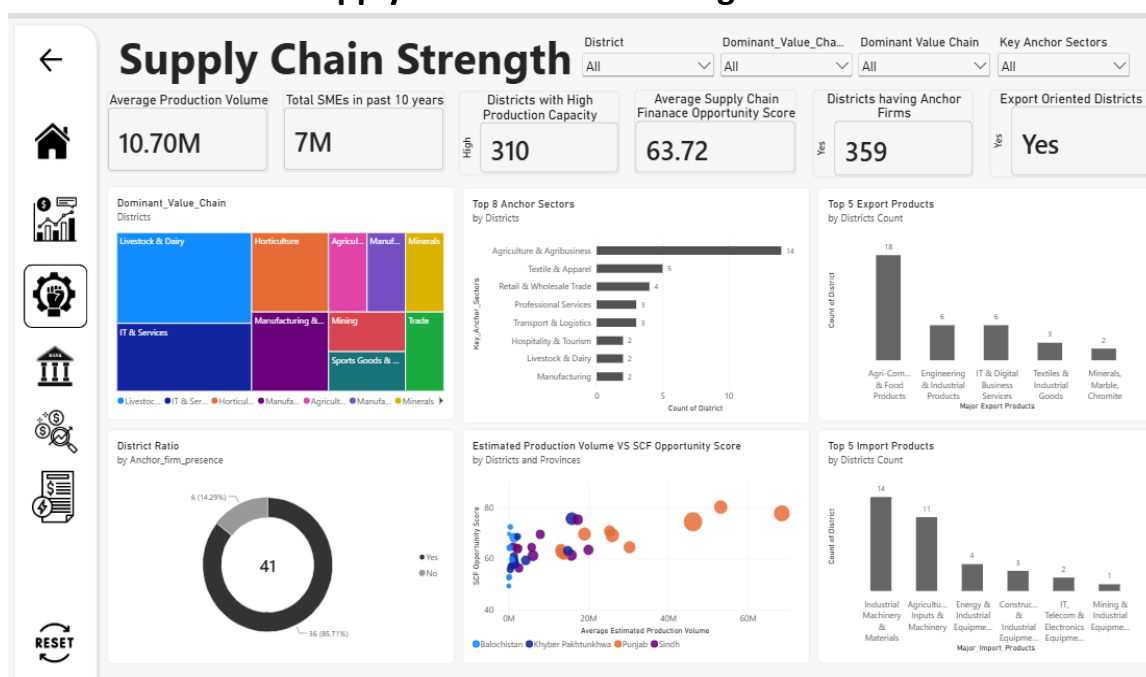
Key Findings:

- **Market Scale:** 41 districts, 17 value chains, 7M SMEs analyzed (2016–2025).
- **Financing Gap:** Working Capital Score of 72.97 (high need) vs. Banking Penetration of 53% — nearly half the market remains unbanked. This is the core opportunity.
- **Opportunity Score:** Average 63.72 (Medium). Most district-year observations fall in the Medium category.
- **Geographic Ranking:** Punjab leads (69), followed by Sindh (64), KP (62), Balochistan (60). Top districts: Gujranwala, Faisalabad, Peshawar, Karachi West, Lahore.
- **Key Value Chains:** IT & Services, Textile, Light Engineering & Manufacturing, Horticulture, Manufacturing & Trade.
- **Growth Trend:** Production volume up gradually in 10 years— from 7.8M (2016) to 14.8M (2025).

Strategic Takeaway:

A sizeable, growing SME ecosystem with strong working-capital needs but only 53% banking penetration. Medium overall opportunity, with Punjab and select districts offering the highest yield. The 47% unbanked gap is the primary target for SCF deployment.

7.3.2. Dashboard 2: Supply Chain Finance Strength



Purpose

This dashboard evaluates **supply-chain strength and readiness across Pakistan's districts**, focusing on anchor firms, SME scale, and trade flows to identify SCF opportunities.

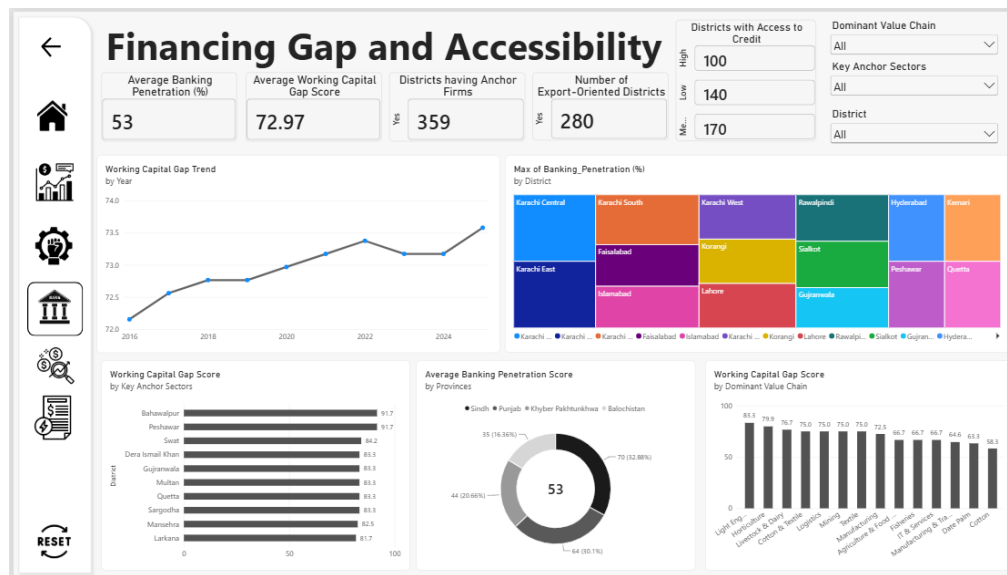
Key Observations:

- **Scale:** Avg. production volume 10.70M, with 7M SMEs active over the last decade. Avg. SCF Opportunity Score: 63.72 (Medium).
- **Anchor Ecosystem:** 85.71% of districts (36/41) have anchor firms, providing a strong base for SCF deployment. Agriculture & Agribusiness leads (14 districts), followed by Textile & Apparel (5) and Retail/Wholesale (4).
- **Trade Flows:** Exports are led by Agri-Commerce & Food Products (18 districts), Engineering (6), and IT Services (6). Imports are driven by Industrial Machinery (14) and Agricultural Inputs (11).
- **Geographic Pattern:** Higher production volume correlates with higher SCF Opportunity Scores, with Punjab and Sindh leading.

Strategic Takeaway:

Pakistan's SCF market is structurally ready for deployment. With anchor firms present in 85.71% of districts, a 7M SME base, and active export/import flows across agricultural and industrial sectors, the ecosystem is secure and structured. Priority: Anchor-led value chains in Punjab and Sindh should be targeted first, where production volume and opportunity scores are highest.

7.3.3. Dashboard 3: Financing Gap and Accessibility



Purpose:

Evaluate financial inclusion and liquidity constraints to identify where structured SCF interventions can resolve working-capital gaps.

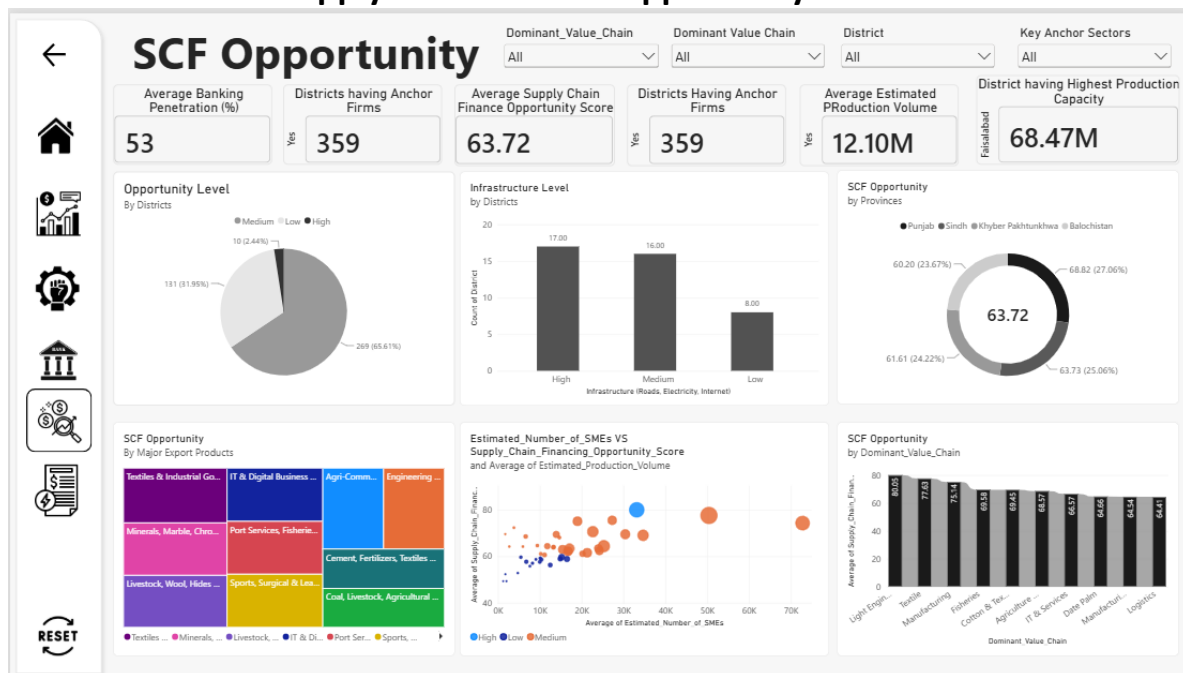
Key Findings:

- **Core Gap:** Banking penetration is 53% vs. Working Capital Gap Score of 72.97, across 359 anchor and 280 export-oriented districts.
- **Credit Access:** Only 100 observations have High access; 140 Low and 170 Medium — credit remains concentrated.
- **Worsening Trend:** Gap Score increased from ~72.1 (2016) to ~73.6 (2025), indicating a structural liquidity shortage.
- **Provincial Divide:** Banking penetration leads in Punjab (70 / 32.88%), followed by Sindh (64), KP (44), and Balochistan (35).
- **Highest Gaps:** Bahawalpur (91.7) and Peshawar (91.7) lead, followed by Swat, D.I. Khan, Gujranwala, Multan, Quetta, Sargodha, Mansehra, and Larkana.
- **Value Chain Pressure:** Highest needs are in Light Engineering (83.3), Horticulture (79.9), Livestock & Dairy (76.7), and Textiles (75.0).

Strategic Takeaway:

A decade-long working-capital deficit persists across Pakistan's key sectors, compounded by uneven banking access. Highest gaps in Light Engineering, Horticulture, and Textiles highlight a clear opportunity for anchor-backed SCF to bridge liquidity gaps in under-served districts.

7.3.4. Dashboard 4: Supply Chain Finance Opportunity



Purpose:

Identify high-potential districts, provinces, export products, and value chains to drive structured SCF growth.

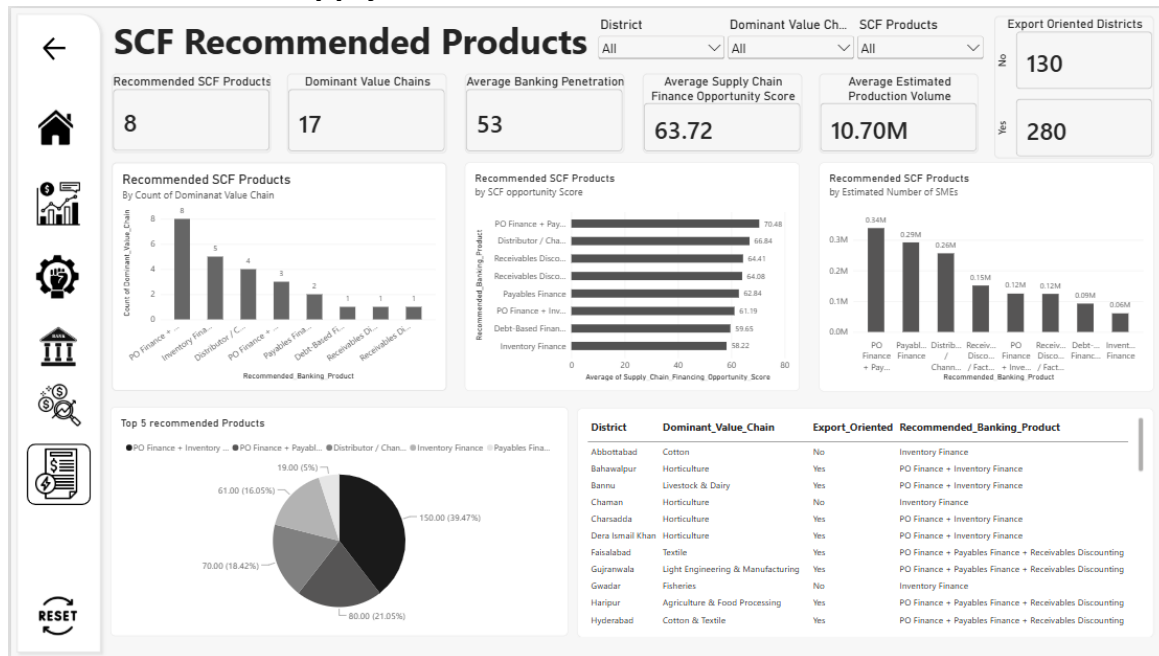
Key Findings:

- **Core Benchmarks:** Average SCF Opportunity Score 63.72 (Medium) with estimated production volume of 12.10M.
- **Anchor Ecosystem:** 359 districts have anchor-firm presence — a ready foundation for supplier, distributor, and value-chain financing.
- **Production Leader:** Faisalabad leads all districts at 68.47M production volume.
- **Opportunity & Infrastructure:**
 - **Opportunity distribution:** Medium (65.61%), Low (31.95%), High (2.44%) — only 10 districts in the High category.
 - **Infrastructure:** 17 High, 16 Medium, 8 Low — indicating readiness in select districts.
- **Provincial Ranking:** Punjab leads (68.82), followed by Sindh (63.73), KP (61.61), and Balochistan (60.20) — scores are closely grouped.
- **Top Value Chains:** Light Engineering (80.05), Textile (77.63), Manufacturing (75.14), Fisheries (69.58), Cotton & Textile (69.45), Agriculture (68.57).

Strategic Takeaway:

SCF potential is substantial and well-distributed across Pakistan. With anchor firms in 359 districts and high-scoring value chains like Light Engineering and Textiles, financial institutions have a clear roadmap. Priority: High-opportunity districts (only 10) and top value chains should be targeted to maximize yield, while building toward Medium-opportunity markets.

7.3.5. Dashboard 5: Supply Chain Finance Recommended Products



Purpose:

Match 8 tailored SCF products to 17 value chains and regional industry profiles for commercial banks and policymakers.

Key Findings:

- **Portfolio Scale:** 8 SCF products mapped across 17 value chains. Avg. Opportunity Score 63.72; Avg. Production Volume 10.70M. Split: 280 export-oriented vs. 130 non-export districts.
- **Dominant Recommendation:** PO Finance + Inventory Finance leads at 39.47% (150 instances), covering the most value chains (8). Followed by PO + Payables + Receivables Discounting at 21.05% (80 instances).
- **Highest-Yield Product:** PO + Payables + Receivables Discounting scores highest at 70.48 and reaches the largest SME base (0.34M). Distributor/Channel Finance follows at 66.84.

- **Regional Product Fit:**

- **Horticulture & Livestock districts (Bahawalpur, Charsadda, D.I. Khan, Bannu):** PO + Inventory Finance.
- **Industrial/Export hubs (Faisalabad - Textile, Gujranwala - Light Engineering, Hyderabad - Cotton):** Multi-product suite (PO + Payables + Receivables).
- **Non-export/raw trade districts (Abbottabad, Chaman, Gwadar):** Standalone Inventory Finance.

Strategic Takeaway:

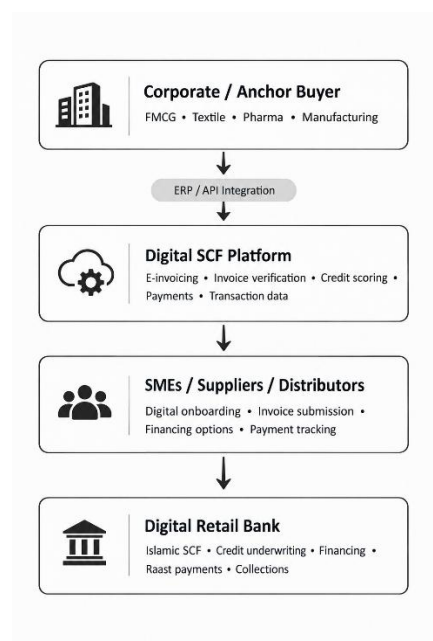
No one-size-fits-all SCF product exists. High-value export hubs require multi-tier working capital suites (PO + Payables + Receivables), while agri and non-export districts are best served by focused Inventory and PO Finance. Priority: deploy the multi-product suite in Faisalabad, Gujranwala, and Hyderabad first — highest yield (70.48) and largest SME reach (0.34M).

8. Strategic Implications for a Pakistani Digital Retail

DRB can adopt a digital, anchor-led and transaction-based SCF model, connecting corporate anchors, SMEs, suppliers and distributors through a digital platform. Financing decisions can be supported by verified invoices, purchase orders, transaction history and anchor payment commitments.

8.3. Proposed SCF Model for a Pakistani Digital Retail Bank

The benchmarked models suggest a layered SCF architecture in which the Digital Retail Bank connects corporate anchors, suppliers/distributors, digital infrastructure, and financing.



8.4. Product opportunities:

Product	Priority	Rationale
Supplier Finance (Islamic)	High	Proven model (Haball/Wisaaq); high demand; bank-funded
Payables Finance	High	Anchor-led; self-liquidating; short tenor
Receivables Discounting	Medium	Digital invoice-based; requires strong e-invoicing
Distributor Finance	High	Core Haball model; large addressable market
Purchase Order Finance	Medium	Higher risk; requires PO verification capability
Dynamic Discounting	Medium	C2FO model; buyer-funded, lower bank capital intensity
Cross-Border B2B Payments	Medium	Export/import SME corridors; requires FX/Raast capability

8.5. Technology capabilities:

- **Digital onboarding:** e-KYC for SMEs and distributors
- **E-invoicing:** FBR-compliant invoice generation and verification
- **ERP/API integration:** Anchor system connectivity (SAP, Oracle, custom)
- **Automated credit scoring:** Transaction-based underwriting using anchor data
- **Digital collections:** Automated repayment via Raast mandates
- **Real-time tracking:** Invoice-to-payment lifecycle visibility

8.6. Strategic Model

The proposed model combines Haball's anchor-led Islamic SCF, C2FO's supplier-focused marketplace approach, and Veem's digital payment infrastructure. The DRB can therefore provide financing and banking services while using digital technology to connect and serve the wider supply-chain ecosystem

8.7. Key risks

Risk	Mitigation
Invoice fraud/duplication	Digital invoice registry; anchor verification; blockchain audit trail
Buyer/anchor concentration	Diversify across anchors and sectors
Credit risk	Anchor-backed structure; transaction-based limits; insurance
Anchor dependency	Multi-anchor strategy; platform not tied to single anchor
Data quality	ERP integration; automated validation; reconciliation workflows
Cybersecurity	SOC2/ISO certification; API security; data encryption
Shariah compliance	Dedicated Shariah advisory board; product certification
Regulatory	PSO/PSP licensing; SBP compliance; FBR e-invoicing

9. Conclusion

Pakistan's Supply Chain Finance (SCF) market presents a meaningful opportunity for a Digital Retail Bank to address persistent working-capital constraints across SME supply chains. The analysis of 41 districts, 17 value chains and an estimated 7 million SMEs indicates an average SCF Opportunity Score of 63.72, alongside a Working Capital Gap Score of 72.97 and 53% banking penetration. The presence of anchor firms across 85.71% of districts further provides a strong foundation for transaction-based and anchor-led financing.

The benchmark analysis demonstrates three complementary capabilities relevant to an SCF strategy: Haball's anchor-led and Islamic financing model, C2FO's supplier-focused working-capital marketplace, and Veem's digital B2B payment infrastructure. Together, these models highlight the value of combining financing, payments, transaction data and digital connectivity within a single ecosystem.

For a Pakistani Digital Retail Bank, the opportunity is therefore to build a digital, anchor-led and transaction-based SCF ecosystem rather than offer isolated lending products. Priority capabilities include digital onboarding, e-invoicing, ERP/API integration, transaction-based credit assessment, automated collections and real-time invoice-to-payment tracking.

The analysis also indicates that SCF should be value-chain and transaction specific. PO Finance, Inventory Finance, Payables Finance and Receivables Discounting emerge as key product opportunities, with product combinations varying according to anchor presence, export orientation and industry structure. This creates scope for targeted deployment across high-potential industrial, textile, agricultural and trade-oriented value chains rather than a one-size-fits-all approach.

Overall, SCF can become a strategic component of the Digital Retail Bank's SME proposition by linking corporate anchors, SMEs, suppliers and distributors through digital transaction flows. A phased approach—starting with anchor-rich and higher-opportunity value chains, supported by strong risk controls and digital infrastructure—can establish the foundation for a scalable SCF platform serving Pakistan's underserved working-capital market.

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